

Akella Raghavendra Sir
Founder & Chief Mentor

[GS III - ECONOMY] | **Publication Date: 30/08/2026**

Water-Smart Farming with Per Drop More Crop



> *PDMC promotes micro-irrigation, efficient water use, higher productivity, reduced agricultural inputs, improved farmer incomes, groundwater conservation, and sustainable, climate-resilient agriculture across India.*

Water-Smart Farming with Per Drop More Crop

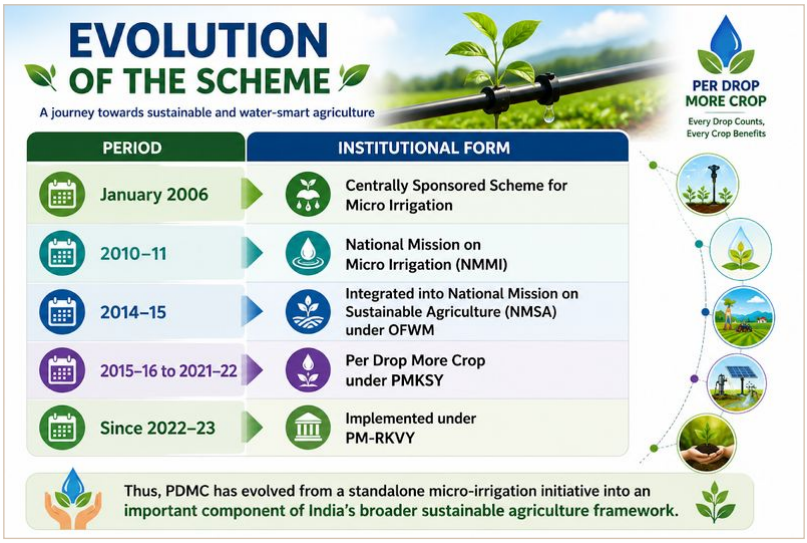
Syllabus Areas:

GS III - Economy

Per Drop More Crop (PDMC) promotes micro-irrigation to enhance water-use efficiency and agricultural productivity. As of July 2026, it covers 115 lakh hectares. DBT and digital implementation improve transparency, while micro-irrigation delivers water savings, higher yields, lower costs, and increased farmers' incomes.

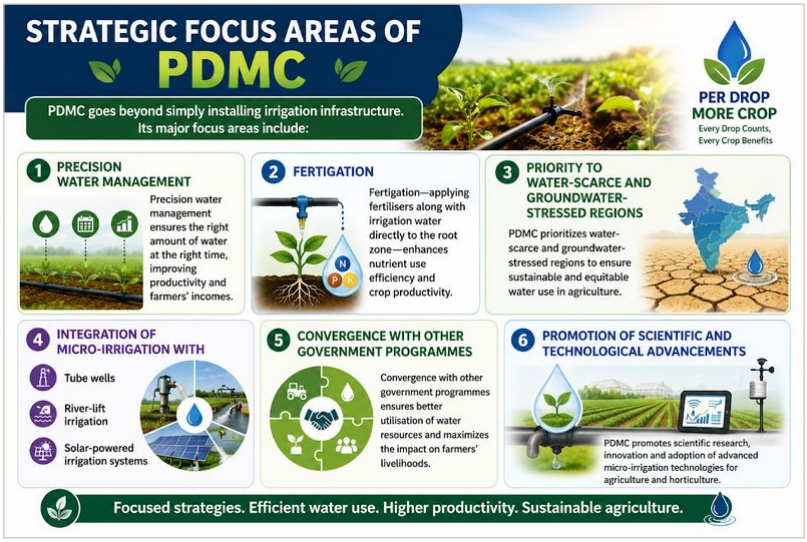
Need for Efficient Irrigation in India

- More than **80% of India's available water resources** are used for agricultural irrigation.
- At the same time, only around **50% of the net sown area** has irrigation facilities.
- This makes improvement in **water-use efficiency** a major national priority.
- Micro-irrigation addresses this challenge by delivering water directly to crops while minimising losses.



PDMC under PM-RKVY

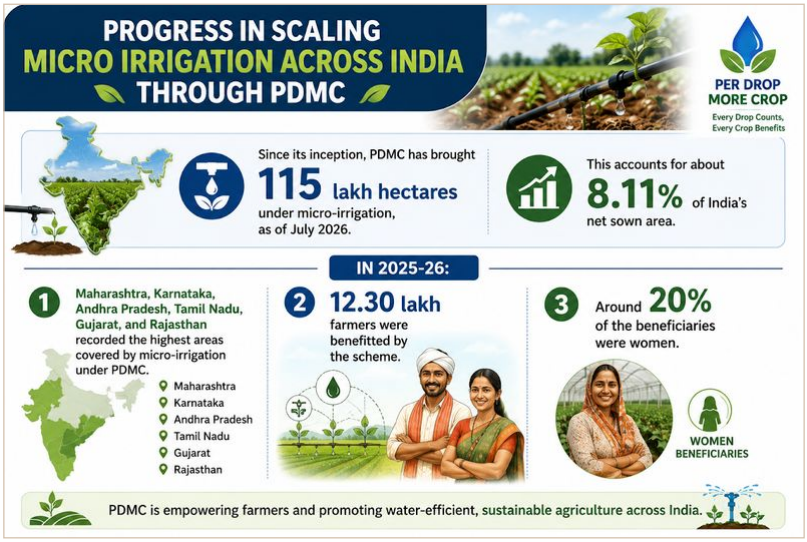
- **Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana (RKVY)** was launched in **2007–08** for holistic development of agriculture and allied sectors.
- It was restructured as **Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana (PM-RKVY)** in **October 2024**.
- PM-RKVY functions as an **umbrella scheme merging nine schemes**.
- It covers areas such as:
- Per Drop More Crop
- Agricultural mechanisation
- Soil health management
- Crop diversification
- Agri-startup accelerator fund
- States have flexibility to **reallocate funds between components** according to their local agricultural requirements.
- During **2025–26**, Rs. 8,957.72 crore was released/sanctioned for PM-RKVY, including **Rs. 3,226.36 crore for PDMC**.



Benefits of Micro-Irrigation

- Micro-irrigation enables efficient use of water by delivering it directly to the plant root zone, reducing wastage and improving irrigation efficiency.
- It lowers the use of water, energy, fertilizers, and labour while supporting better crop growth and higher productivity through the precise application of water and nutrients.

- The technology also encourages the cultivation of horticultural crops, improves cropping intensity, and brings marginal lands under productive use.
- By reducing input costs and enhancing farm returns, micro-irrigation contributes to sustainable agriculture, strengthens farmers' livelihoods, and promotes long-term food and nutritional security.



New Flexibility for Water Conservation

PDMC has introduced greater flexibility for states and UTs to undertake **micro-level water storage and conservation activities**.

These include:

- **Diggis** — large water storage tanks/farm ponds.
- Water harvesting systems.
- Individual as well as community-level water conservation structures.

These interventions aim to ensure **reliable and sustainable water availability** for micro-irrigation.

Earlier, expenditure on such activities under the "Other Interventions" component was capped at:

- **20%** of allocation for general States/UTs.
- **40%** for North-Eastern States, Himalayan States and the UTs of Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh.

The revised guidelines allow States/UTs to **exceed these limits according to their local requirements**

Also Read Types of Micro-Irrigation under PDMC